

Section B (further issues)

For this section:

- assessment continues without pause or interruption into this section
- the teacher/examiner must introduce at least two further issues for discussion. Students must **not** know in advance of the assessment which further issues the teacher/examiner will choose for discussion, **these must be unpredictable elements of the assessment**
- the teacher/examiner should cover a range of issues for discussion across the centre

- students will be rewarded for the ability to respond to the spoken language, so it is important that the teacher/examiner's questions are sufficiently challenging both linguistically and conceptually to allow the student to access the full range of marks
- the teacher/examiner must ensure that the unpredictable issues in this unit are linked to the GTAs described in the specification. All students at IA2 will be expected to have covered the seven GTAs to some degree, and students who are able to demonstrate good knowledge of any of these areas should be rewarded accordingly
- unpredictable issues which relate to the four IAS/IAL general topic areas do not have to refer to French-speaking culture, although they may. However, issues which relate to the three IA2 specific general topic areas **must** refer to French-speaking culture.
- the teacher/examiner must not require the student to produce any very detailed or specialised knowledge in the follow-on unpredictable discussions
- in the assessment, students have approximately 6 to 8 minutes' discussion time.

Administration and general information about the conduct of the speaking assessment

Oral chosen issue form (OR3)

- Students must submit an *Oral chosen issue form (OR3)* to the teacher/examiner in advance of the assessment.
- Students must declare on their form the issue for their debate and include a statement that indicates the stance that they are taking on the particular issue.
- Students are allowed to refer to their *Oral chosen issue form (OR3)*, but they are not allowed to write additional notes on it. It will be checked by the teacher/examiner in the examination room.
- Scanned forms will not be accepted for submission to Pearson. Electronically completed forms must be sent as directed in the *Administrative support guide*.

Assessment window

It is usual for teachers to conduct the speaking assessment with their students during one of two timetabled assessment windows in November/December or in April/May. Information will be available on the Pearson qualifications website: qualifications.pearson.com

Sample assessment materials

Sample marking criteria (including guidance of how these criteria are applied) can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel International Advanced level in French Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* documents.

Marking guidance has been written to accompany the SAMs and is included with the SAMs booklet. Please note that this guidance is for the use of the Pearson-appointed external examiner, who will mark the assessments. They are printed for reference only so as to aid understanding of how the criteria are applied.

3.3 Assessment criteria

General guidance on using levels-based mark schemes

There are five levels-based mark grids to be applied to the presentation and debate. The mark grids are:

- spontaneity and development (AO1)
- quality of language (Accuracy) (AO3)
- quality of language (Range of lexis) (AO3)
- reading and research (AO2)
- critical analysis (AO4).

Deciding on a marking band

- First of all, the examiner will consider the performance as a whole and then decide which descriptors most closely match the performance and place it in that band. The descriptors for each band indicate the different features that will be seen in the student's performance for that band.
- When assigning a band, the examiner will look at the overall quality of the performance and not focus disproportionately on small and specific parts where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the performance covers different aspects of different bands of the mark scheme, the examiner will use a 'best fit' approach for defining the band.

Using grids with a range of marks within bands

- Then, the examiner will use the variability of the performance to help decide the mark within the band that they have selected. For example, if the performance is predominantly band 6-10 with a small amount of band 11-15 material, it would be placed in band 6-10 but be awarded a mark near the top of the band because of the band 11-15 content.
- The examiner will modify the mark based on how securely the trait descriptors are met at that band.

Spontaneity and development (AO1)

This mark grid assesses students' ability to interact with the examiner by giving relevant responses based on what they have heard.

Mark	Spontaneity and development: AO1
0	No rewardable material.
1–5	- Minimal spontaneity. - Cannot develop responses. - Often fails to respond or needs regular prompting. - Very reliant on examiner's language.
6–10	- Some examples of spontaneity. - Limited development of responses. - Some hesitation in more complex areas. - Difficulty with some questions.
11–15	- Many examples of spontaneity. - Some development of responses. - Responds usually without undue hesitation. - Deals adequately in most situations.
16–20	- High incidence of spontaneous, fluent discourse. - Detailed development of responses. - Able to respond readily to all questions. - Develops and sustains discourse well.

Quality of language (Accuracy) (AO3)

The following mark grid assesses students' ability to apply grammar and syntax accurately, as well as accuracy of pronunciation.

Mark	Quality of language (Accuracy): AO3
0	No rewardable material.
1	- Isolated examples of correct language. - Poor pronunciation and intonation.
2	- Many basic errors, often impeding communication. - Pronunciation and intonation not always comprehensible.
3	- Accuracy variable, basic errors sometimes impede communication. - Pronunciation and intonation comprehensible.
4	- Generally accurate but some errors in more complex language, communication rarely impeded. - Pronunciation and intonation generally good.

Quality of language (Range of lexis) (A03)

The following mark grid assesses students' ability to use a range of lexis and structures.

Mark	Quality of language (Range of lexis): A03
0	No rewardable material.
1	Very basic lexis; minimal command of structure.
2	Lexis restricted; operates generally in simple sentences.
3	Adequate range of lexis; limited range of structures.
4	Good range of lexis with some examples of more complex structures.
5	Wide range of lexis and good variety of structures with only occasional limitation.

Reading and research (A02)

This mark grid assesses students' reading and research skills using French-language written source material for their presentation and other French-language source material for the debate.

Mark	Reading and research (Debate only): A02
0	No rewardable material.
1	• Scant evidence of any reading and research into the chosen issue. • Very superficial.
2	• Little evidence of reading and research into the chosen issue. • Obvious gaps and very little detail.
3	• Adequate evidence of reading and research into the chosen issue, but overall lacks breadth and detail. • Somewhat inconsistent.
4	• Good to very good evidence of wide reading and research into the chosen issue with occasional gaps. • Some pertinent detail at times.
5	• Excellent evidence of in-depth and very wide reading and research into the chosen issue. • Excellent detail.

Critical analysis (A04)

This mark grid assesses students' ability to critically analyse key issues.

Mark	Critical analysis: A04
0	No rewardable material.
1	• Only superficial engagement with key issues. • Limited links between ideas, leading to limited coherence throughout.
2	• Partial explanations of key issues. • Occasional links between ideas and some attempts to justify these.
3	• Full explanation of key issues. • Some justified links between ideas, and coherent arguments are sometimes present.
4	• A critical analysis of key issues, albeit inconsistent. • Justified links between ideas, with coherent arguments mostly present that show a developing individual response.
5	• A full evaluation of key issues. • Consistently justified links between ideas, often well substantiated with insightful observations that form a well-rounded individual response.